

# Licensing Policy Consultation Results

## Regulatory Services

DECEMBER 2025

## Contents

|                           |    |
|---------------------------|----|
| Executive Summary         | 3  |
| Methodology               | 7  |
| Consultation Objectives   | 7  |
| In-Person Engagement      | 9  |
| Digital & Print Promotion | 10 |
| Email Communications      | 10 |
| Online Promotion          | 11 |
| Consultation Results      | 12 |
| Key Themes                | 23 |
| Conclusion                | 23 |

# Executive Summary

- 1.1 As required under the Licensing Act 2003, a comprehensive review of the Licensing Policy was undertaken. This report provides an overview of the statutory requirements for the Licensing Policy 2026–2031 consultation, how these requirements were met, participation metrics, key results, and conclusions on compliance and impact.

## Legal requirement

- 1.2 The Licensing Act 2003 came into effect on 25 November 2005. The Act introduced a legal framework for local authorities to administer and regulate licensable activities, namely, alcohol, regulated entertainment, and late-night refreshment.
- 1.3 The Act <sup>1</sup>requires each licensing authority to prepare and publish a statement of the licensing policy every five years. The policy statement is expected to set out for the benefit of applicants, responsible authorities and members of the local community, how the authority intends to approach its licensing responsibilities under the Act. In determining its policy, the council is exercising a licensing function and, as such, must have regard to the guidance issued by the Secretary of State under section 182 of the Act<sup>2</sup>.
- 1.3 Each authority is also required to keep the statement of policy under review throughout its term and make appropriate revisions as necessary. Every revision of the policy is required by law to be subject of full public consultation.
- 1.4 Southwark's current Statement of Licensing Policy is set to expire in 2026, necessitating a comprehensive public consultation to ensure the revised policy meets legal obligations and reflects community needs.

## Balancing Interests

- 1.5 Southwark Council faces the challenge of balancing multiple priorities while meeting its legal duties under the Act. The policy must encompass alcohol, entertainment, and late-night refreshment, each with its own set of implications for public safety and community harmony. The four licensing objectives—prevention of crime and disorder, public safety, prevention of public nuisance, and protection of children from harm—serve as the guiding principles for policy development.
- 1.6 Achieving these objectives required a refined approach that considers the needs of businesses, residents, and enforcement agencies. The council must ensure that the policy is clear, enforceable, and adaptable to changing circumstances. This involves addressing issues such as anti-social behaviour, noise complaints, and underage drinking, which are

---

<sup>1</sup> Section 5 of the Licensing Act 2003

<sup>2</sup> Revised guidance was issued in November 2025

often linked to licensed premises. The challenge lies in creating a policy that is both robust and flexible, capable of promoting a safe and vibrant environment.

- 1.7 The revised policy addresses the licensing requirements of alcohol, regulated entertainment, and late-night refreshment and the licensing objectives, all of which have significant impacts on residents and businesses.

## **Communication and Consultation Process**

- 1.8 The consultation process was designed to be inclusive and participatory, ensuring that all voices were heard and considered. By engaging a diverse range of stakeholders, the council ensured the policy reflected community priorities while meeting statutory obligations. This approach demonstrated a commitment to transparency and fairness, making the consultation a genuine opportunity for engagement rather than a formality.
- 1.8 The engagement was structured into two phases. Phase One involved preliminary stakeholder engagement to inform the draft policy, while Phase Two was the formal public consultation, open to all members of the public and stakeholder organisations. This phased approach allowed for early input from key stakeholders and broad community engagement during the main consultation period.
- 1.9 Stakeholder engagement included both internal and external participants. Internally, the Licensing Committee, Licensing Team, Responsible Authorities, Public Health, Equalities Team, Legal Services, Community Safety.
- 1.10 Cabinet members contributed expertise in policy development, legal compliance, public health, and community engagement.
- 1.11 Externally, statutory consultees such as the police and fire authorities were consulted, alongside license holders, local businesses, community groups, faith organisations, and residents. These diverse perspectives ensured that the policy was informed by a wide range of experiences and priorities.
- 1.12 Recognising that many residents and businesses were unaware of the policy or its impact, officers adopted a two-pronged strategy. The first element was a communication plan designed to maximise presence on digital platforms and through printed materials. The second was a consultation plan that captured a variety of outreach methods to raise awareness and encourage participation. This dual approach ensured that engagement was both proactive and accessible.
- 1.13 Formal channels played a key role in meeting statutory requirements and engaging professional stakeholders. Emails were sent to statutory consultees and professional bodies, while website updates and e-newsletters provided transparency and easy access for those already engaged with council communications. Targeted questions during the consultation focused on awareness, impact, and clarity, generating actionable insights that could directly inform policy revisions. These formal methods built credibility and ensured compliance.

- 1.14 Alongside formal channels, community-centric outreach extended engagement beyond the usual voices. Social media campaigns broadened reach to residents and community groups, while QR codes placed in libraries and public spaces enabled quick access to consultation materials. Leaflet distribution through Southwark's Young Advisors targeted youth audiences, and engagement with faith organisations and town centre businesses tapped into trusted networks. These methods demonstrated cultural sensitivity and inclusivity, ensuring that underrepresented groups were actively involved.
- 1.15 Tailored messaging was another critical element of the strategy. Recognising that different audiences have varying levels of awareness and engagement preferences, the council adapted tone and format accordingly. Professional stakeholders received formal, detailed communications, while residents and community groups were approached with clear, relatable language. Collaboration with the Community Harm and Exploitation group and the schools' safeguarding coordinator ensured outreach to vulnerable and youth populations. This tailoring improved trust, relevance, and the quality of feedback.
- 1.16 Accessibility and inclusion were prioritised throughout the process. Feedback mechanisms were designed to be user-friendly, allowing stakeholders to share views easily. The adaptive online and offline strategy ensured messages were clear and accessible, meeting people where they are and using language that resonates. Respondents were asked to rate licensing objectives such as crime prevention, public safety, and protection of children, and were invited to suggest improvements. This approach demonstrated the council's commitment to inclusive governance and produced a more representative policy aligned with Southwark's diverse community.

## Summary

- 1.17 As per the requirements of the Act, the council consulted on the revision of its Statement of The Licensing Policy 2026-31. The council complied with all statutory duties through:
- a six-week statutory consultation was held from 19 September to 31 October 2025.
  - engagement channels included online surveys, drop-in sessions, officer visits, leaflet distribution, and targeted outreach engagements.
  - Promotion via email campaigns, website/email banners, and QR codes in libraries.
  - Feedback recorded, analysed, and, where appropriate, incorporated into the final policy draft.

**Participation Metrics:** The consultation achieved broad engagement through multiple channels:

| Channel                                             | Footprint | Responses |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| Online Survey Responses                             | 51        | 51        |
| Drop-in Sessions<br>(5 sessions, 3 attendees total) | 3         | 3         |
| Officer Visits                                      | 75        | 75        |
| Emails                                              | 11        | 11        |

| Channel                                                                                                                                                   | Footprint                                                       | Reviewed by |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Digital Footprint Website                                                                                                                                 | unlimited                                                       | unknown     |
| Digital Footprint Social Media                                                                                                                            | Approx. 100,000 over all channels                               | unknown     |
| Newsletters – Residents, Community Safety and Reg Services                                                                                                | Excess of 1300                                                  | unknown     |
| E-Newsletters Town Centre businesses                                                                                                                      | Approx. 14,000                                                  | unknown     |
| Forums - Partnership Tasking Group and Safer Neighbourhood Panels meetings                                                                                | Approx 50 attendees                                             | unknown     |
| Notification of the policy consultation was also emailed out to 193 registered faith groups and 499 groups registered on Southwark's engagement platform. | 193 registered faith groups and 499 groups engagement platform. | unknown     |

#### 1.18 Key takeaways as follows

- Policy Clarity: Majority of respondents agreed the draft policy was clear and balanced.
- Licensing Objectives: Strong support for maintaining the four statutory objectives.
- Cumulative Impact Areas: Mixed views and need for greater enforcement.
- Late-Night Concerns: Issues raised about noise, safety, and enforcement, which align with the council's ASB review.

## Conclusion

1.19 The consultation fully complied with legislative requirements, ensuring statutory consultees and the wider community were engaged. The results have informed actionable recommendations and shaped the final Licensing Policy 2026–2031, supporting robust, transparent, and inclusive licensing governance.

# Methodology

- 1.1. The London Borough of Southwark is required under Section 5 of the 2003 Act to prepare and publish a statement of licensing policy every five years. The policy statement is expected to set out, for the benefit of applicants, responsible authorities and members of the local community, how the authority intends to approach its licensing responsibilities under the Act. The current policy expires in January 2026, and the new policy will cover the period 2026–2031. This section details the community engagement and communication plans undertaken to undertake the consultation.
- 1.2. Under the Licensing Act 2003, Southwark Council, as the designated local licensing authority, has a statutory duty to consult when preparing or updating its Statement of Licensing Policy. The consultation must have regard to the Secretary of State's guidance issued under Section 182 of the Licensing Act, and the policy must promote the following four licensing objectives:
  - The prevention of crime and disorder
  - Public safety
  - The prevention of public nuisance
  - The protection of children from harm
- 1.3 The purpose of the policy is to:
  - To reinforce legal context for decision-makers to guide applicants and stakeholders; and set out the parameters under which the authority will make licensing decisions, offering clarity to prospective applicants, responsible authorities, residents, and licensed operators.
  - To inform operational expectations - helping prospective licensees understand how a licensed premises is likely to be able to operate within the borough.
  - To address community and business needs - It informs both residents and licensed operators about how their needs and concerns will be considered in licensing decisions.
  - To reduce legal challenges - It aims to minimise the number of licensing decisions that may be subject to legal challenge, by ensuring transparency and consistency in decision-making.
- 1.4 The policy seeks to provide the necessary balance between responsible business operators contributing towards a thriving business and a late-night economy, whilst ensuring that the quality of life of those who live and work in the Borough is protected and enhanced through the licensing system.

## 2. Consultation Objectives

- 2.1 The objectives of the consultation were to:
  - Ensure compliance with statutory requirements for public consultation.
  - Engage residents, businesses, and community groups to gather feedback.
  - Promote inclusivity and accessibility through multiple engagement channels.

- 2.2 To achieve these objectives, a comprehensive consultation engagement plan was undertaken, which was designed to increase awareness of the process among Southwark businesses, residents and communities, provide easy access to the online survey and detailed consultation information, and maximise engagement through multiple communication channels to ensure diverse community participation.
- 2.3 The consultation was also designed to be inclusive with the purpose of engaging and seeking feedback from various stakeholders, businesses, residents and communities on Southwark Council's Statement of Licensing Policy under the Licensing Act 2003.
- 2.4 Stakeholders were identified using a mix of legal requirements, local knowledge, and community insight. This included:
- Statutory bodies as required by the Licensing Act 2003.
  - Council teams and partners involved in community safety, public health, and enforcement.
  - Businesses and licence holders, including pubs, clubs, off-licences, and event organisers.
  - Residents and community groups, especially in areas with known licensing concerns.
  - Workshops to identify additional groups to reach a wider audience, including existing licence holders and Southwark's community.
  - Community engagement team – discussions to identify communities.
  - Consultation team – discussions to identify communities and faith groups to communicate with.
  - Working with local networks and trusted partners to reach a greater audience
- 2.5 To ensure we reached a wider audience, a communication plan and community engagement plan was produced, identifying various methods and channels of communication. This included:
- Stakeholder mailing lists
  - Mailing list to all licence holders.
  - Mailing list to Town Centre residents and businesses
  - In-person attendance and distribution of QR codes.
  - Social media via the council's Twitter account, Facebook.
  - The council's webpage and the council's consultation hub.
  - Press release.
  - Personal LinkedIn.
  - Providing QR codes at all libraries within LBS to reach wider audiences and communities.
- 2.6 The engagement process was set out in two phases:
- Phase one - a preliminary stakeholder engagement to inform and shape the draft policy
- Stakeholder consultation, workshops and meetings were held with a range of partners, including responsible authorities, public health, licensing committee and police. These sessions provided a platform for sharing insights into key issues such as noise, anti-social behaviour, and business needs.
  - Officers attended local Safer Neighbourhood Panel meetings and planned action days with community safety. These meetings flagged concerns such as late-night disturbances and informed the officers where better communication about licensing might be needed.



The process enabled stakeholders to contribute their expertise, and by working together, the council and its partners identified approaches and achieved consensus around policy priorities. This approach helped shape the policy revision before the formal public consultation took place.

#### Phase Two – statutory consultation (6 weeks)

This was the main consultation period, which was open to all members of the public and stakeholder organisations. Respondents were asked a series of questions focused on awareness of the licensing policy, its perceived impact on local communities, and the clarity and fairness of its objectives. They were asked to rate the importance of licensing objectives such as crime prevention, public safety, and protection of children. They were also invited to suggest improvements and comment on the policy's understanding.

- 2.7 A 6-week statutory public consultation took place from 19 September to 31 October 2025 on the Statement of Licensing Policy.
- 2.8 The consultation undertaken sought to gather feedback from residents, businesses, and stakeholders on the Licensing Policy under the Licensing Act 2003. This involved:

|                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diverse Target Groups            | Engagement includes officials, authorities, community leaders, businesses, residents, and faith groups to ensure wide representation.                                                                                                                                            |
| Effective Communication Channels | Multiple channels, such as mailing lists, social media, websites, QR codes, public events and press releases, were used to reach stakeholders and to increase awareness and understanding.                                                                                       |
| Engagement Activities            | surveys, direct outreach, and events for participation and gathering comprehensive community feedback.                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Statutory consultees             | The chief officer of police for the licensing authority's area, the fire authority, representatives of holders of premises licences and club premises certificates, representatives of holders of personal licences and representatives of businesses and residents in its area. |
| Other                            | Safer Neighbourhood Panels, neighbouring authorities, officer engagements during visits conducted and with businesses in Town centres, LBS councillors, all current licence holders within the borough.                                                                          |

### **3. In-Person Engagement**

- 3.1 Throughout the consultation process, various stakeholders' meetings were held to discuss and promote awareness of the policy, and officers collaborated with community safety during public events held to promote women's safety and to raise awareness of the policy.
- 3.2 Five drop-in sessions were held across council offices at Tooley Street and Queens Road to engage with businesses, residents and communities to answer questions and encourage participation regarding the licensing policy review.
- 3.3 Forums, Partnership Tasking Group and Safer Neighbourhood Panels meetings were attended by officers to raise awareness of the policy consultation, changes undertaken and to encourage promotion of the policy to others within their networks.

- 3.4 Officers engaged with businesses during inspections and visits around the borough and collaborated with Town Centre Leads within the borough's town centres to engage directly with them concerning the policy review, completing surveys and providing information on how to access the consultation online.
- 3.5 Collaborative work was undertaken with Southwark's Young Advisors team, engaging in their services to distribute consultation leaflets within the community, aiming to expand our reach among the youth in Southwark.

## **4. Digital & Print Promotion**

- 4.1 QR codes were placed across all Southwark libraries to provide residents with quick and easy access to the online survey and full consultation details. The QR code provided a convenient entry point for residents to participate in the consultation.
- 4.2 Information about the consultation was shared through multiple established channels, including Town Centre e-newsletters and Safeguarding Bulletins.
- 4.3 Leveraging multiple communication channels ensured that information reached a wide audience, including those who engage through print, email, and digital platforms
- 4.4 The consultation was actively promoted via The Southwark Council website, social media campaigns, such as Facebook and X and Newsletters and Town Centre e-newsletters. This increased visibility across social media and newsletters encouraged participation and feedback.

## **5. Email Communications**

- 5.1 The consultation included engagements with both statutory and non-statutory stakeholders and email notifications, which provided details of the consultation, online consultation webpage link and QR codes were sent to all statutory consultees, including all LBS Councillors, Responsible Authorities, neighbouring boroughs, all LBS licence holders, Citizens Advice, Urban Health, local schools and safeguarding leads, community and faith groups.
- 5.2 Notification of the policy consultation was also emailed out to 193 registered faith groups and 499 groups registered on Southwark's engagement platform.
- 5.3 With support from the consultation team emails were sent to various diverse community outreach groups, namely:
  - LOVO (Ladies of Virtue) – Women's group
  - Aaina Women's Group – BAME Women's Group – based in Peckham
  - Pecan – VCS Organisation that supports residents and Women's Group – Peckham
  - Blackfriars – VCS group- community sessions/workshops/ advice centre for Southwark residents

- SGTO – (TRAs) – Southwark Group of Tenant Organisations. (Tenants and Residents Association) –
- ASKI – BAME (older persons organisation in Peckham)
- CBACE – contacts – BAME older persons community groups in Southwark.
  - ▶ Golden Oldies
  - ▶ Age Concern
  - ▶ Time and Talents

A policy consultation banner was also added to officers' Email signatures to promote consultation.

## 6. Online Promotion

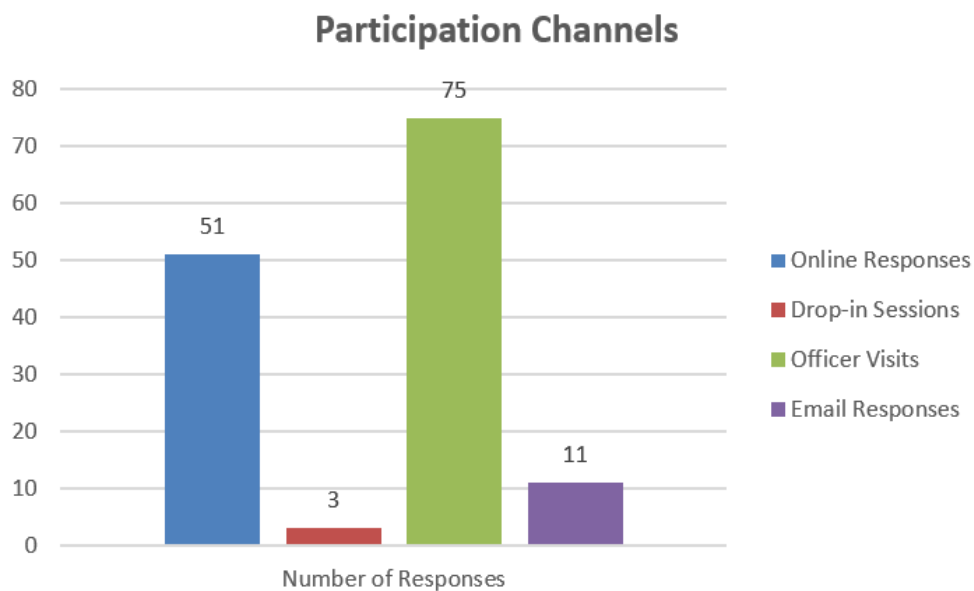
- 6.1 A formal consultation webpage was created, providing further information on the policy changes and updates and extension of the Late Night Levy to include late night refreshment premises operating between 00:00 (midnight) and 06:00.
- 6.2 This webpage provided information concerning policy changes made, extension of the late night levy, a link to the current policy, a copy of the revised draft 2026-31 policy, details of drop-in sessions being held during the consultation, and an online survey for participants to complete.
- 6.3 The online survey sought to highlight the importance of the policy within the borough, with key messaging “Your views matter” – help shape licensing in Southwark. Emphasis was placed on fairness, inclusion, and community safety. Encouraging participation from all residents and businesses.

### Summary Table of Engagement Actions

| Activity Type        | Details                                                                                                |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Drop-in Sessions     | Queens Road, Tooley Street – officers engaged with residents.                                          |
| Leaflet Distribution | Libraries across Southwark with QR codes for online consultation and an online survey.                 |
| Email Outreach       | Councillors, Responsible Authorities, schools, community and faith groups.                             |
| Officer Visits       | Licensed premises used questionnaires and/or referred to the dedicated consultation page for feedback. |
| Online Promotion     | Licensing webpage banner, QR codes, and email signatures updated.                                      |

## 7. Consultation Results

- 7.1 The consultation took place from 19 September to 31 October 2025 and aimed to gather views from residents, businesses, and community groups. The statutory consultation received responses from a broad range of stakeholders, including residents, businesses, Responsible Authorities, and community groups.
- 7.2 The consultation achieved broad engagement through various channels. Below is the breakdown of participation by channel and feedback themes.
- 7.3 The chart below shows the feedback received from the consultation across 4 segments: online responses, drop-in sessions, email responses and officer visits.



### Online Survey Results

- 7.4 The online platform provided a simple process, making the consultation more accessible and inclusive for all, allowing for broader participation, community engagement and supporting democratic accountability by including diverse perspectives. It also represented a transparent and efficient way to collect, analyse responses.

| About you 51/51 responses                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>2. Are you.....</b></p> <p>51/51 - Multiple choice - choose many - required</p> <p>This helps us to understand who we are reaching with our public surveys.</p> <p>Resident 66.7% (34 choices)</p> <p>Business 23.5% (12 choices)</p> <p>Community Group 7.8% (4 choices)</p> <p>Licence Holder 5.9% (3 choices)</p> <p>Licensing Consultant 3.9% (2 choices)</p> <p>Legal Representative (Licensing) 0% (0 choices)</p> <p>Other (please specify) 7.8% (4 choices)</p> | <p>Respondents represent a range of stakeholders, including councillors (some with specific portfolios such as climate emergency, jobs, and business), political groups (Southwark Liberal Democrats), and public health professionals. The most common trend is that feedback is coming from individuals with a professional or organisational interest in licensing policy, rather than from private residents or business owners.</p> <p>This suggests that the consultation is engaging key institutional voices, particularly those concerned with public health, local governance, and political oversight.</p> <p>No detailed policy comments or specific issues have been raised in these responses, but the diversity of roles indicates a broad interest in how licensing policy intersects with public health, business, and local political priorities.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <p><b>3. Are you aware that Southwark has a licensing Policy?</b></p> <p>51/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional</p> <p>Yes 78.4% (40 choices)</p> <p>Not Sure 11.8% (6 choices)</p> <p>No 9.8% (5 choices)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p><b>4. If yes, where did you hear about it?</b></p> <p>19/51 - Short answer - optional</p> <p>Most respondents mentioned hearing about Southwark's licensing policy consultation through council communications, such as council emails or previous consultations on licence applications. Residents' meetings, particularly those addressing anti-social behaviour (ASB) issues in Camberwell Green, were also cited as sources of information. There was also a mention of awareness due to legal requirements.</p> <p>Overall, council channels and meetings are the main ways people hear about licensing policy consultations, which were covered under this consultation.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>5. How do you think licensing affects you and your local area?</b></p> <p>40/51 - Long answer - optional</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <p>82% of respondents raised concerns about antisocial behaviour (ASB), noise, and public nuisance linked to licensed premises, particularly late-night venues and off-licences. Many mentioned issues such as loud music, fighting, shouting, public urination, littering, and violence. Several respondents specifically highlighted problems around off-licences selling alcohol late and the resulting gatherings and block parties, which disrupt sleep and create safety concerns.</p> <p>There was frustration about a lack of effective enforcement and unclear council directives on how to report breaches or influence licensing decisions. Some felt their complaints were ignored or not acted upon by authorities.</p> <p>Concerns were also raised about the proliferation of fast-food outlets, particularly on Walworth Road, with respondents noting negative impacts on the high street's vibrancy and cleanliness due to refuse and unhealthy food options.</p> <p>A minority view suggested that more licensed premises could actually improve social cohesion and vibrancy in the borough, arguing that noise is an expected part of central London life and that licensed venues do not necessarily increase ASB as much as perceived. One</p> |

|                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                              | <p>respondent emphasised the importance of a well-implemented licensing policy to protect residents from nuisance.</p> <p>Overall, the dominant themes were concerns about ASB, noise, safety, ineffective enforcement, and the negative impact of certain licensed premises on local quality of life.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <p><b>6. Are there specific issues related to licensed premises in your area that concern you?</b></p> <p>37/51 - Long answer - optional</p> | <p>Respondents most frequently raised concerns about noise from licensed premises, particularly late at night, which disrupts residents' quality of life. Anti-social behaviour (ASB), including arguing, shouting, violence, and drug use near off-licences and parks, was also a common concern. Respondents highlighted issues with underage drinking and littering, such as laughing gas canisters and rubbish left outside licensed premises.</p> <p>There was a repeated perception that licensing limitations are not respected and that enforcement by the council and police is lacking or invisible.</p> |

## Draft Licensing Policy 2026/31 - Policy and Content

48/51 responses

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>7. Is the policy clear and easily understood?</b></p> <p>47/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional</p> <p>Somewhat agree 41.2% (21 choices)</p> <p>Neither agree nor disagree 21.6% (11 choices)</p> <p>Strongly agree 11.8% (6 choices)</p> <p>Somewhat disagree 9.8% (5 choices)</p> <p>Strongly disagree 7.8% (4 choices)</p> <p>No answer 7.8% (4 choices)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p><b>8. Are the amendments to the policy balanced, fair and reasonable?</b></p> <p>48/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional</p> <p>Neither agree nor disagree 31.4% (16 choices)</p> <p>Somewhat disagree 29.4% (15 choices)</p> <p>Somewhat agree 19.6% (10 choices)</p> <p>Strongly agree 11.8% (6 choices)</p> <p>No answer 7.8% (4 choices)</p> <p>Strongly disagree 0% (0 choices)</p> |
| <p><b>9. Does the policy clearly set out the authority approach to maintaining and upholding the licensing objectives as set out by statute?</b></p> <p>45/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Prevention of crime and disorder</li> <li>Public safety</li> <li>Prevention of public nuisance</li> <li>Protection of children from harm</li> </ul> <p>Somewhat agree 29.4% (15 choices)</p> <p>Neither agree nor disagree 19.6% (10 choices)</p> <p>Somewhat disagree 17.6% (9 choices)</p> <p>Strongly agree 13.7% (7 choices)</p> <p>No answer 11.8% (6 choices)</p> <p>Strongly disagree 7.8% (4 choices)</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

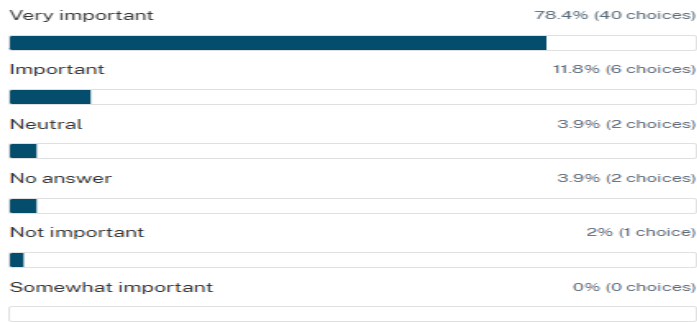
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>More than half of respondents indicated that the policy was clear and easily understood, while only 17% disagreed with this statement. Regarding the fairness and balance of the amendments, one third of respondents felt the changes were not balanced, fair, or reasonable. Notably, approximately 60% of respondents agreed that the policy clearly sets out the authority's approach to maintaining and upholding the statutory licensing objectives, although 20% remained unsure.</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <p><b>10. What changes would you like to see, and how do you think these will support local business and residents?</b></p> <p>36/51-Long answer -optional</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <p>Many respondents expressed concerns about late-night licences and alcohol sales, particularly in residential areas, with several calling for stricter controls or a complete stop to late drinking and all-night sales. There were repeated requests for clearer processes for residents to complain about breaches and for licensees to understand their responsibilities, including more transparency and follow-up from the council. Some respondents highlighted the need to balance residents' rights to peace and quiet with the desire for safe and enjoyable late-night experiences, suggesting that complaints should only trigger action when there is unreasonable disturbance. Concerns were also raised about the proliferation of fast-food retailers and specific issues with off-licences in certain estates.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>11. Do you have any other comments or suggestions regarding the licensing policy?</b></p> <p>26/51-Long answer -optional</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <p>Many respondents expressed concerns about the negative impact of late-night licensed premises, particularly bars, pubs, and off-licences, on residents and public safety. There were repeated calls for stricter policies on opening hours, with suggestions to limit alcohol sales and close establishments by 11 pm to help reduce crime, anti-social behaviour, and disturbances. Several comments highlighted issues with enforcement, stating that licence conditions are often ignored and not properly monitored, leading to ongoing problems for residents. There was a sense that the current policy does not adequately address residents' concerns or the root causes of nuisance and crime, and that businesses abusing the system are not deterred. Some respondents called for more focus on tackling crime and anti-social behaviour in specific areas, such as Camberwell.</p> <p>A few responses emphasised the need for a fairer balance, recognising the social, cultural, and employment benefits of licensed activities, and suggested the policy should not be overly restrictive.</p> <p>Technical and procedural issues were raised, including the requirement for scale plans and transfers during reviews. Concerns were also raised about the need to submit both existing and proposed plans for variations when only proposed plans are necessary, adding that it was noted that plans were omitted from licences and should be included.</p> <p>Overall, the most common themes were concerns about late-night alcohol sales, enforcement of licence conditions, and the impact on residents and public safety.</p> |
| <p><b>Licensing objectives</b> 49/51 responses</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |



## 12. How important are the four licensing objectives to you?

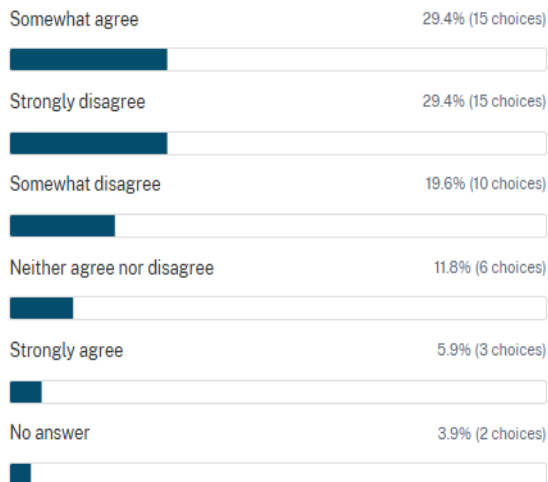
49/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional

- Prevention of crime and disorder
- Public safety
- Prevention of public nuisance
- Protection of children from harm



## 13. Do you think the licensing objectives are met in your area?

49/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional



## 14. Please explain your answer

26/51 - Long answer - optional

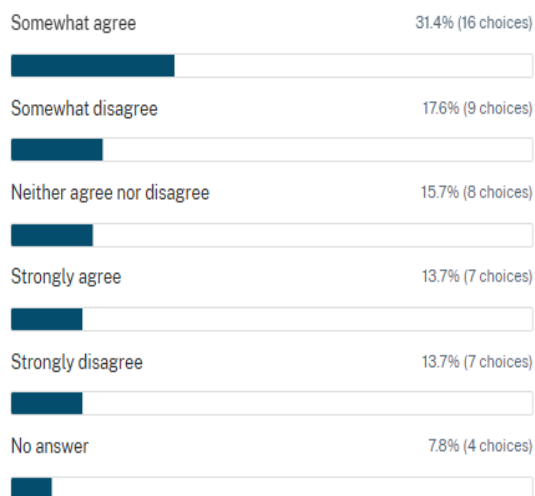
Respondents most frequently raised concerns about noise nuisance and anti-social behaviour (ASB) linked to licensed premises, particularly those with late or 24-hour alcohol sales. Many felt that current licensing is not effectively monitored or enforced, leading to persistent problems with crime, disorder, and public nuisance, especially in areas like Camberwell and around Rye Lane. Several respondents highlighted a lack of communication or visible action from the council or authorities after complaints are made.

There were also concerns that the licensing process is too complicated, favouring larger businesses over local ones, and that not enough attention is paid to residents' needs. Some respondents specifically mentioned issues with certain types of businesses (e.g. vape shops, off-licences) attracting problematic behaviour.

Overall, the dominant themes were dissatisfaction with enforcement, concerns about noise and ASB, and a desire for more effective action and consideration for local residents.

## 15. Do you feel the licensing policy addresses the four objectives?

48/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional



## 16. Please explain your answer

20/51 - Long answer - optional

Many respondents expressed concerns about insufficient enforcement and a lack of resources to support the licensing policy, particularly in relation to police and council teams being unable to address breaches, noise, and anti-social behaviour (ASB) effectively. Several highlighted that businesses exploit this lack of enforcement, leading to increased crime, disorder, and public nuisance, with residents feeling demoralised and unsupported.

There was repeated mention of alcohol-related issues, including the negative impact of off-licences near residential areas and parks, contributing to ASB and making neighbourhoods feel unsafe. Some respondents felt the policy does not do enough to curb problematic alcohol sales or address the resulting disorder.

Some responses criticised the policy for being too vague or lacking explicit measures in detail. There were calls for the policy to clearly set out recommended conditions and practical steps for applicants, as well as for more tailored approaches to different types of venues and events.



|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | <p>A minority of responses noted that the policy provides a solid foundation or broadly supports the licensing objectives. There were also comments about the balance between regulation and the benefits licensed premises bring to society, with some suggesting that overly restrictive measures (such as on late-night food) may have unintended negative consequences.</p> <p>Overall, the most common themes were the lack of effective enforcement, ongoing alcohol-related ASB, and the need for more practical, explicit measures to protect residents and support the licensing objectives.</p> |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

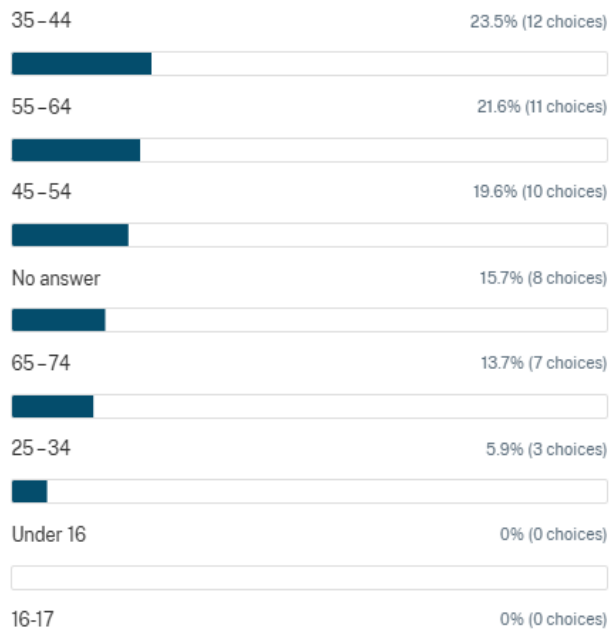
|                                    |                        |
|------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>Accessibility and Diversity</b> | <b>44/51 responses</b> |
|------------------------------------|------------------------|

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>17. Do you think licensing policy easily accessible?</b></p> <p>44/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional</p> <p>Somewhat agree 27.5% (14 choices)</p> <p>Strongly agree 15.7% (8 choices)</p> <p>Neither agree nor disagree 15.7% (8 choices)</p> <p>Somewhat disagree 13.7% (7 choices)</p> <p>Strongly disagree 13.7% (7 choices)</p> <p>No answer 13.7% (7 choices)</p> | <p><b>18. How can we improve communication and engagement with the local community?</b></p> <p>32/51 - Long answer - optional</p> <p>There were no direct concerns relating to accessibility. Respondents mentioned in general terms that communication materials are too lengthy, with one stating that they received 80 pages to review before a licence application hearing meeting, making it difficult for residents to engage without significant time and effort. There is a clear call for clearer, more concise documents and better summaries.</p> <p>Several respondents suggested using newsletters and emails to keep the community informed, with one specifically mentioning updates via the Southwark Council newsletter.</p> <p>There is also a desire for communication to focus more on real, local issues such as crime, public drinking, squatting, littering, homelessness, traffic reduction, and environmental improvements. Respondents want updates on how these problems are being addressed, preferably through social media and newsletters.</p> <p>Overall, the main trends are requests for simpler, more accessible information and more relevant updates on tangible local issues.</p> |
| <p><b>19. How could we improve engagement with residents?</b></p> <p>31/51 - Long answer - optional</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <p>Respondents most frequently emphasised the need for the council to genuinely listen to residents and respond to their concerns, with several expressing frustration at feeling ignored or neglected. There is a strong desire for clearer, simpler communication, including concise policies and summaries, as well as straightforward guidance on how residents can report issues or breaches. Some respondents called for more direct power for residents to object to licensing applications, rather than leaving decisions solely to councillors.</p> <p>A notable comment highlighted a lack of visible action from the council, particularly in Camberwell, with calls for improvements such as more trees, reduced traffic, speed bumps, and addressing noise and anti-social behaviour. The sense of being overlooked and the need for tangible improvements were stressed as key to rebuilding trust and engagement.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

## Demographics

### 20. Age

43/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional

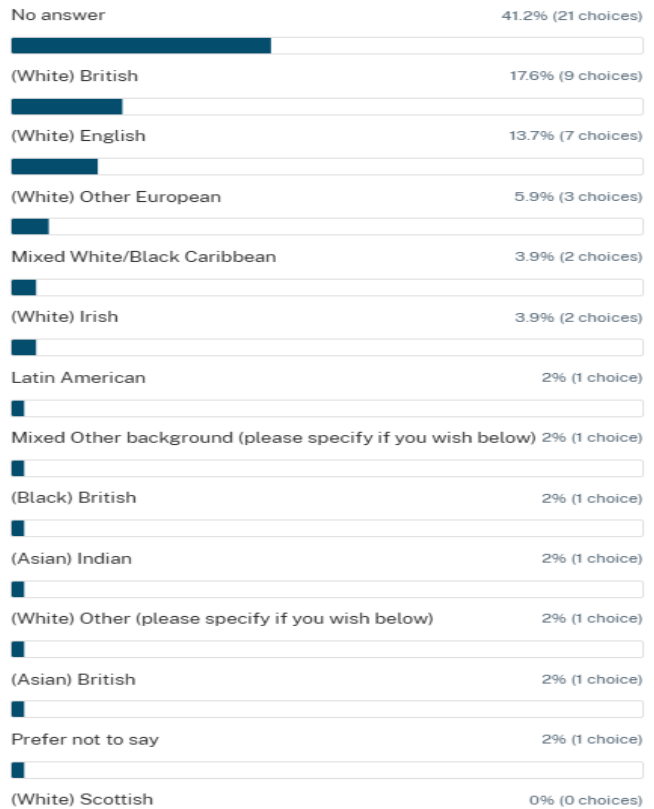


### 22. If Other, please specify further if you wish

0/51 - Short answer - optional

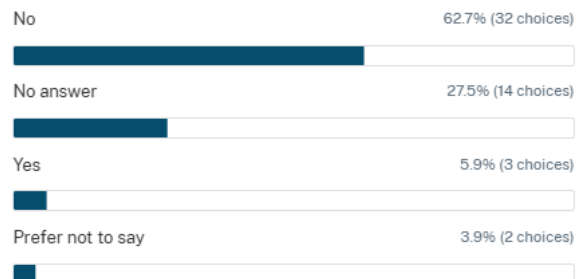
### 21. What is your ethnic background?

30/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional



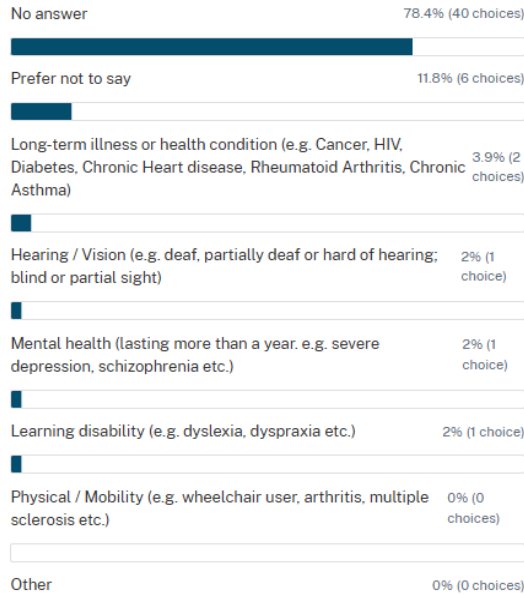
### 23. Are you disabled?

38/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional



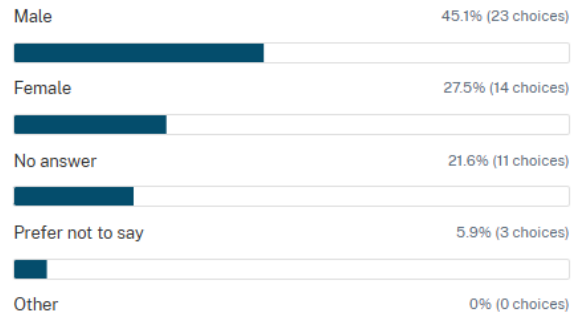
**24. Please tick the box or boxes below that best describe your disability:**

11/51 - Multiple choice - choose many - optional

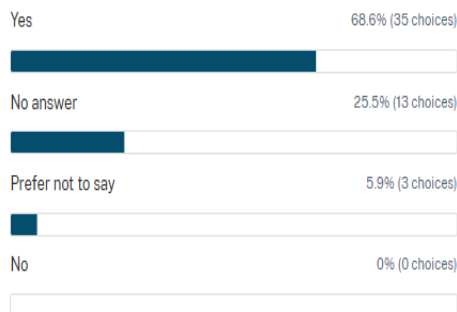
**25. What is your sex as recorded at birth?**

40/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional

(A question about Gender Identity will follow)

**26. Is the Gender you identify with the same as the sex you were recorded at birth?**

38/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional

**27. If no, how would you define your gender identity? Please specify if you wish**

3/51 - Short answer - optional

All responses (3)

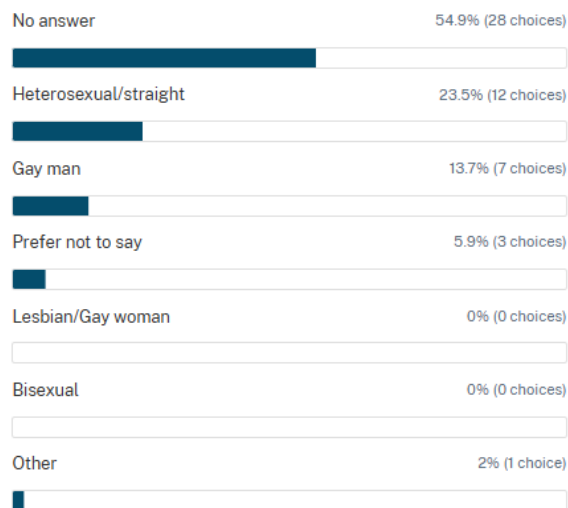
Male

Male

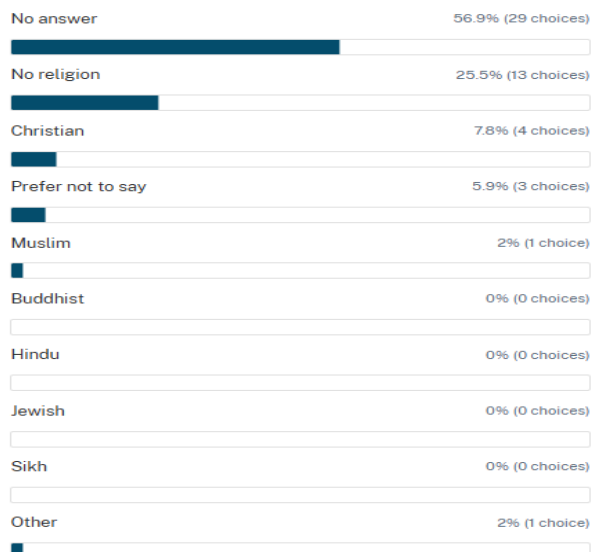
Not sure

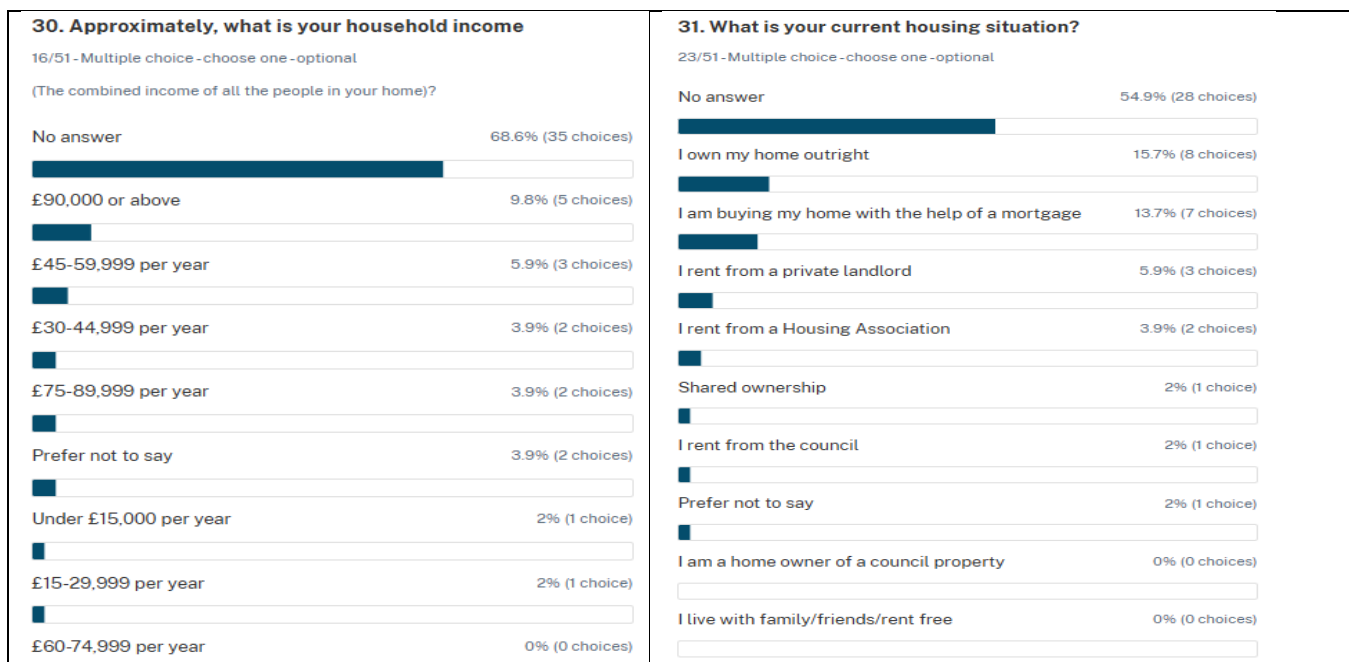
**28. Which of the following best describes your sexual orientation?**

23/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional

**29. What is your religion or belief?**

22/51 - Multiple choice - choose one - optional





### **Drop-in Sessions**

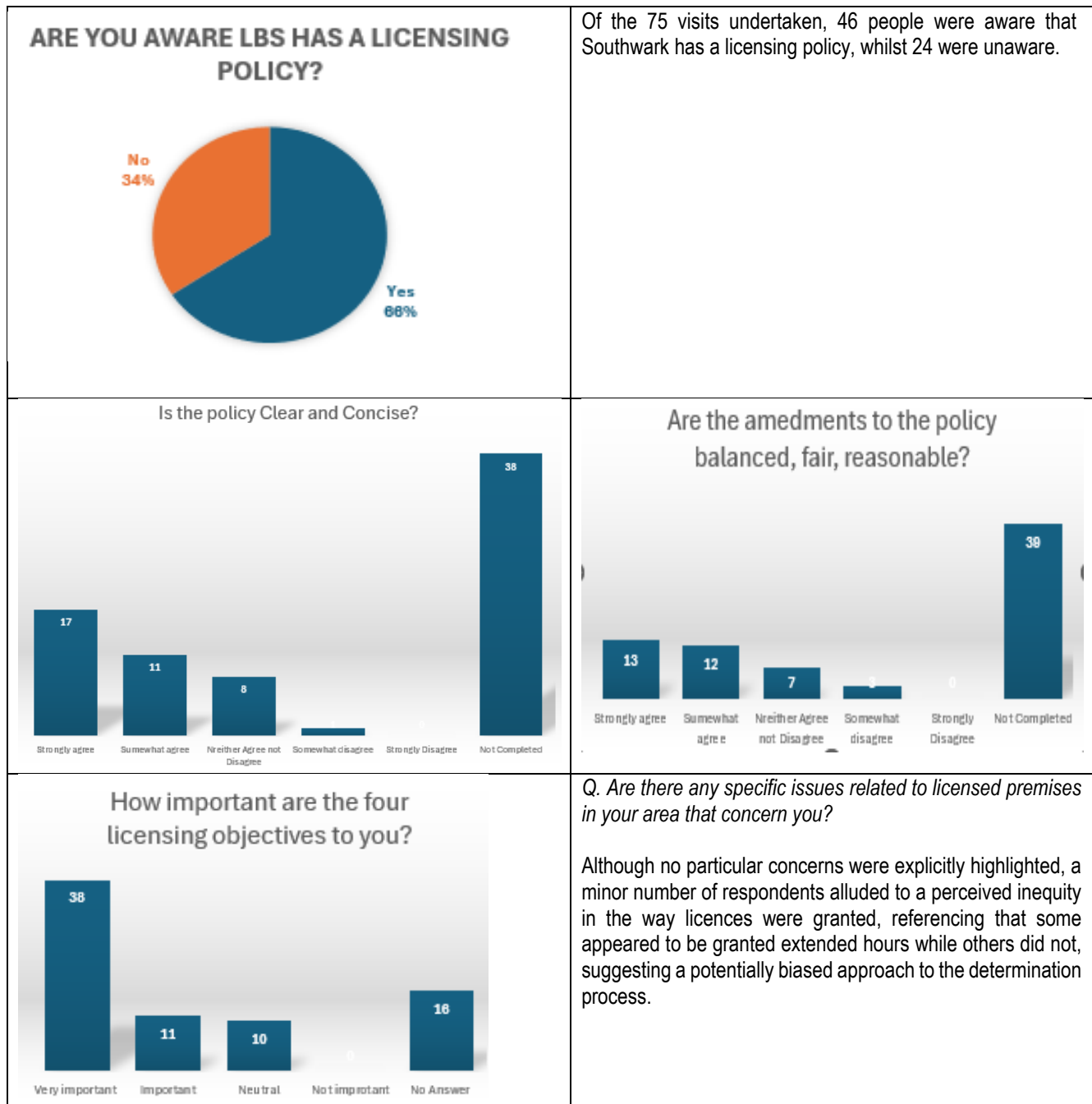
- 7.5 During the consultation period, 5 in-person drop-in sessions were held across the Council offices in Tooley Street and Queen's Road. This process provided opportunities for businesses, residents and stakeholders to attend at their convenience without a prior appointment to ask questions and provide feedback.
- 7.6 All those who attended raised concerns around the ASB and the lack of enforcement concerning late-night off-licences within their area.

### **Email responses**

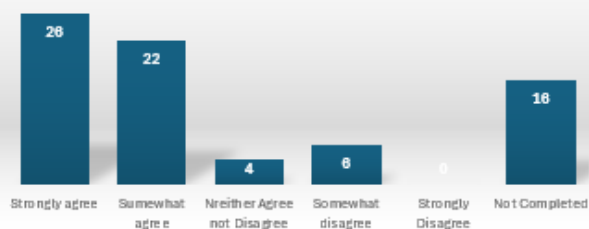
- 7.7 Some respondents raised matters relating to the extent of the boundaries concerning the current cumulative impact areas, while others related to grammatical clarity/corrections within the policy. One respondent expressed concerns about the later closing times for convenience stores and off-licences in residential areas, pointing out that there are many high streets where alcohol can be purchased late at night. Whilst another respondent expressed concerns about the fairness of late-night levy fees being based on business rates. Unfortunately, these fees are determined by statute and are beyond the control of any local licensing authority
- 7.8 Most respondents raised concerns regarding an over-saturation of licensed premises and the lack of responsibility from the businesses, breaches in licensing conditions and the lack of enforcement in the borough. Overall, concerns relating to issues from late-night activities such as noise, ASB, vandalism, theft, overflowing bins and public safety were raised, with some referencing the need for standard conditions on licences and tightening the Temporary Event Notice process.

### **Officer Visit Results**

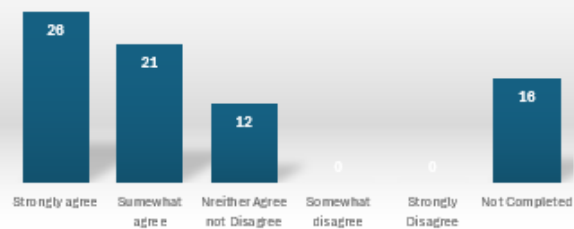
7.9 During the consultation period, officers engaged with businesses on the policy revision during visits and inspections undertaken. This form of personal engagement served to gather diverse, real-life insights, build trust and legitimacy, and empower individuals to influence their views concerning the policy. This approach sought to go beyond simply collecting opinions but to foster a meaningful, two-way dialogue. The survey results are detailed below.



### Do you think the licensing objectives are being met in your area?



### Do you feel the licensing policy addresses the four objectives?

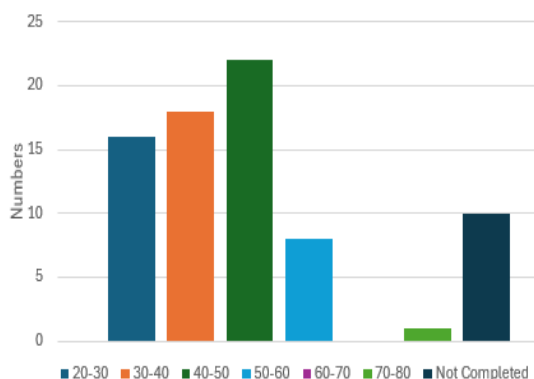


Q. Do you have any other comments or suggestions regarding the licensing policy?

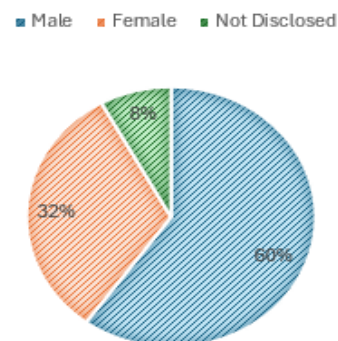
Most respondents offered no additional comments; however, a small minority expressed a desire for extended operating hours to better cater to the vibrant nightlife of the diverse community, referencing that SIA requirements as stringent and a financial cost on the business.

## Demographics

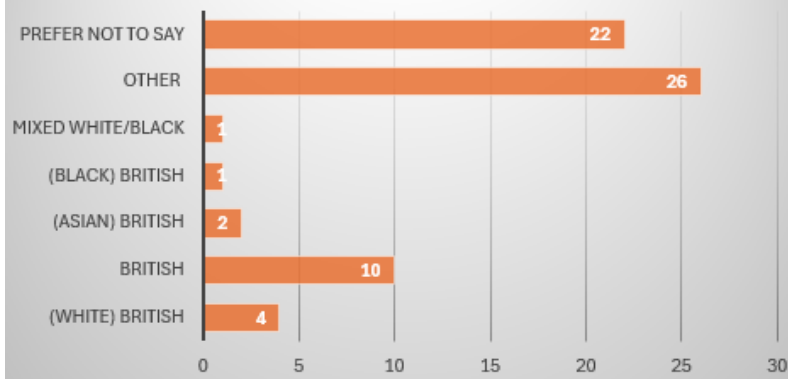
### Officer Engagements - Age



### GENDER



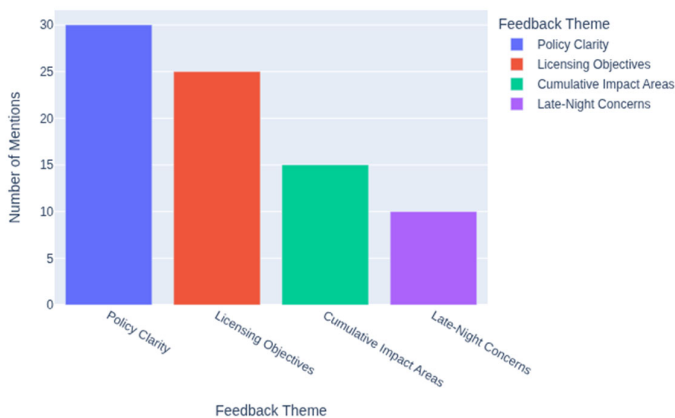
### What is your ethnic background?



## Key Themes

The main themes identified from the consultation feedback were as follows:

Feedback Themes



Policy Clarity: Majority of the respondents agreed the draft policy was clear, fair and balanced.

Licensing Objectives: Strong support for maintaining the four licensing objectives.

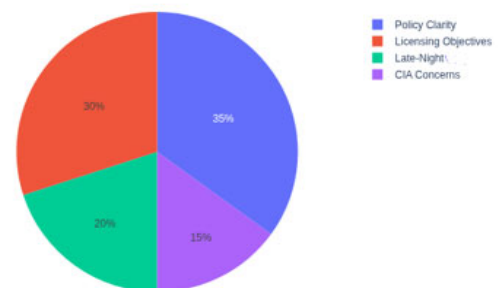
Cumulative Impact Areas: Concerns raised about the lack of enforcement and compliance in CIAs.

Late-Night Concerns: Concerns about the noise, lack of enforcement and public safety.

The majority of the respondents' feedback was that the policy overall provided clarity and was clear on the licensing objectives (65%).

Respondents also highlighted the concerns with the ABS and lack of enforcement within the Cumulative Impact Areas and late at night in general.

Feedback Themes



## Conclusion

The Licensing Policy Consultation for 2026–2031 was conducted in full compliance with statutory requirements, employing a comprehensive multi-channel engagement strategy to ensure inclusive participation from residents, businesses, key stakeholders and the community.

The consultation process has highlighted several operational concerns, particularly relating to the lack of enforcement. It is important to note that these issues are operational in nature and do not impact the substance or direction of the revised licensing policy. The overall response to the policy itself has been positive.

By acknowledging these operational matters separately from policy considerations, we can focus on refining our internal processes and improving service delivery. This distinction allows us to maintain

the integrity of the revised policy while proactively addressing practical challenges, ensuring continued progress and responsiveness to stakeholder feedback.

**Strong Support for Policy Clarity, Balance and Structure.** The majority of respondents agreed that the draft policy was clear, well-structured, and balanced. This clarity was seen as essential for both applicants and residents, ensuring that expectations and requirements are transparent and accessible.

**Endorsement of Licensing Objectives.** There was robust support for maintaining the four statutory licensing objectives. Respondents recognised these objectives as fundamental to promoting public safety, preventing crime and disorder, protecting children from harm, and minimising public nuisance. The policy's continued emphasis on these objectives was widely welcomed.

**Inclusive and Effective Engagement.** The multi-channel approach to consultation—encompassing online surveys, in-person sessions, officer visits, and targeted outreach—was positively received. Stakeholders appreciated the council's efforts to make the process accessible and inclusive, enabling a broad spectrum of voices to be heard, including residents, businesses, community groups, and statutory consultees.

**Overall Feedback.** Many respondents acknowledged the policy's solid foundation and its potential to support a vibrant, safe, and inclusive local economy. However, while the consultation has brought to light significant concerns regarding late-night licensed premises, anti-social behaviour, noise, and the perceived lack of effective enforcement—particularly in cumulative impact areas—it is clear that these issues matter deeply to our community. Respondents have also emphasised the need for clearer communication and greater transparency in enforcement and complaint processes.

Recognising these concerns, we are committed to taking positive steps forward. We will prioritise enhanced enforcement measures, improve communication channels, and ensure transparency throughout our complaint procedures. By addressing these challenges collaboratively, we aim to foster a safer, more responsive environment for all residents and businesses.